



DECISION

Complaint No. : POS/65/2025/KM/KW

Name and address of the complainant : Mst. Prof Samina Khalil, retired Director, AERC, University of Karachi, R/o. House No. 788 , Sector-14-C, Orangi Town, Karachi.

Name of the Agency Complained against : Director, Applied Economics Research Centre (AERC), University of Karachi.

Name & Designation of Investigating Officer : Mr. Aftab Ahmad Khatri, Director, Regional Office, Keamari/West.

Vetted by : Mr. Muhammad Naseer Jamali, Advisor-N.

Subject : **COMPLAINT REGARDING INORDINATE DELAY IN PAYMENT OF SERVICE DUES TO THE COMPLAINANT.**

COMPLAINT

Prof. Dr. Samina Khalil filed a complaint dated 15.04.2025 wherein she stated that she has served in Applied Economics Research Centre (AERC) University of Karachi for 35 years. She retired from service on 22.12.2024 as a Research Professor (BPS-21). The agency has failed to pay her service dues i-e commutation amounting to Rs. 8,996,957 and leave encashment amounting to Rs. 2,968,200/- (total Rs. 11,965,157) despite lapse of more than 03 months. Aggrieved by that, she solicited intervention of this Institution.

PROCEEDINGS

2. The complaint was admitted under Section 10 of the Establishment of the Office of Ombudsman for the Province of Sindh Act, 1991 (amended up to date) after receiving mandatory affidavit on Form 'A', other relevant documents and by condoning the delay.
3. This office issued a notice vide dated 17.04.2025 to the Registrar, University of Karachi for report, followed by reminders. In response, the Director, AERC, University of Karachi informed vide letter dated 21.05.2025 that the complainant had also served as Director, AERC, University of Karachi from July-2016 to July-2022 and alleged some irregularities against the complainant while serving as Director of the agency. She informed that the total outstanding liabilities of retired / deceased employees have been accumulated to Rs. 50,903,408/-. The request for allocation of grant, amounting to Rs. 300 million is under consideration with the relevant forum in order to meet the requirements of AERC.
4. The report of the agency was sent to the complainant for rejoinder vide letter dated 22.05.2025 who in response reiterated her version for payment of service dues.
5. The rejoinder of the complainant was forwarded to the Director, AERC, University of Karachi for comments vide letter dated 11.06.2025, who in response informed vide letter dated 11.07.2025 that the outstanding liabilities on account of payment of service dues to the retired employees have accumulated to Rs. 53,914,669/- from the period 18.09.2021 to 01.02.2025. The case of the complainant is at S. No. 08 in order of "First Retired First Paid" basis and she will be paid her service dues accordingly subject to release of pension grant by Govt. of Sindh.

FINDINGS

6. No maladministration has been established against the agency. However, payment of service dues to the complainant / other retired employees have been delayed dues to non-availability of required funds with the agency.

DECISION

7. In view of the above and in exercise of powers vested in me under Section 11 of the Establishment of the Office of Ombudsman for the Province of Sindh Act, 1991 (amended to date), I, hereby direct the Director, AERC, University of Karachi to pursue the matter for release of funds with Universities & Boards Department, Govt. of Sindh and pay the outstanding liabilities of retired / deceased employees on the basis of FIFO policy. Further, I hereby direct the Secretary, Universities & Boards Department to take up the matter of retired / deceased employees for payment of service dues at appropriate forum without further delay under intimation to this office.

Given under my hand and seal of the office

Sd /-
(MUHAMMAD SOHAIL RAJPUT)
Sitara-e-Imtiaz. PAS
Ombudsman, Sindh

Karachi, dated 21st November, 2025

